

Height and width combinations. Which combinations of height and width perform best? Anything tall outperforms anything short (on average), but see the table for the best results. You'll want to avoid patterns that are both short and narrow.

[Table 64.6](#) shows volume-related statistics.

Volume trend. Linear regression of volume from the pattern's start to its end says that volume trends downward the vast majority of the time. Remember you heard it here first.

[Table 64.6](#) Volume Statistics

Description	Up Breakout	Down Breakout
Volume trend	80% down	78% down
Rising volume trend performance	49%	−11%
Falling volume trend performance	42%	−13%
Heavy breakout volume performance	44%	−13%
Light breakout volume performance	41%	−13%

Rising/Falling volume. Upward breakouts with a rising volume trend see much better performance than those with falling volume. However, we're talking about 20% of the samples with a rising volume trend (that's 177 versus 772). So this result could be because of a lack of samples.

Breakout day volume. Heavy breakout volume helps push price in triangles with upward breakouts to better performance. The push isn't as significant as many imagine, but that's because they probably haven't studied volume like I have (nor offered proof for their beliefs). Another way of saying that is, aren't statistics wonderful? There's an old joke which goes, 90% of statistics are worthless.

[Table 64.7](#) shows how often price reaches a stop location, but it only applies to upward breakouts (because my computer gives misleading results for downward breakouts). I checked how often price returned to the triangle *on the way to the ultimate high*.

If you were to set a stop-loss order at the top of the pattern, an upward breakout would trigger it 73% of the time. You might think that's low, but